

Semester wrap-up assignment

PHY-905-003

Computational Astrophysics and Astrostatistics
Spring 2026

This assignment is due the evening of Wednesday April 22, 2026. Turn in all materials via the GitHub Classroom.

The goal of this final pre-class assignment is to have you spend a bit of time reflecting on what you've learned in this class and how it might be useful to you in the future. The idea is for you to synthesize and summarize your thoughts about the course, but don't spend too much time on this. **Please spend no more than one hour on this entire assignment!** To be clear, there are not right or wrong answers here – I just want to hear your thoughts about what you've learned from this class! This will also inform the discussion that we have in class the day after the assignment is done.

In the included `ANSWERS.md` file, please answer the following questions:

1. Please take a bit of time to look back through the various pre-class and in-class assignments before answering this question! What were the most interesting and/or important things that you've learned from this class?
2. When you think about the arc of the entire semester, what were the broad themes that emerged from the topics that we've explored? In other words, what were your key "big picture" takeaways from this class in terms of numerical and statistical methods? (Note that I'm not looking for specific topics here - I'm really looking for a synthesis of the overarching themes you took away from the course.)
3. How do you think what you've learned in this class will be useful to you in the future? (Other than making you a real challenge for seminar speakers during the Q&A period, that is.)
4. What topics did you learn about in this class that you would have liked us to spend more time on, or topics that we didn't cover that you wish we had done?
5. What are your plans for the summer, both for work and personally?

In addition to answering those questions in the included markdown file, please take a few minutes to fill out the online SIRS form (found at <https://sirsonline.msu.edu/>) so I can get your feedback on how the class went! In the free-response area of the SIRS form, I usually ask students to answer three questions:

1. What aspects of the class helped you learn the materials?
2. What aspects of class could I improve next time I teach this class?
3. Do you have any other comments about this class, or suggestions for how I can improve my teaching?

It would be great if you could answer those, or some subset of them, because the written feedback on my teaching is a lot more useful to me than the numerical ratings.

Thank you for a great semester!